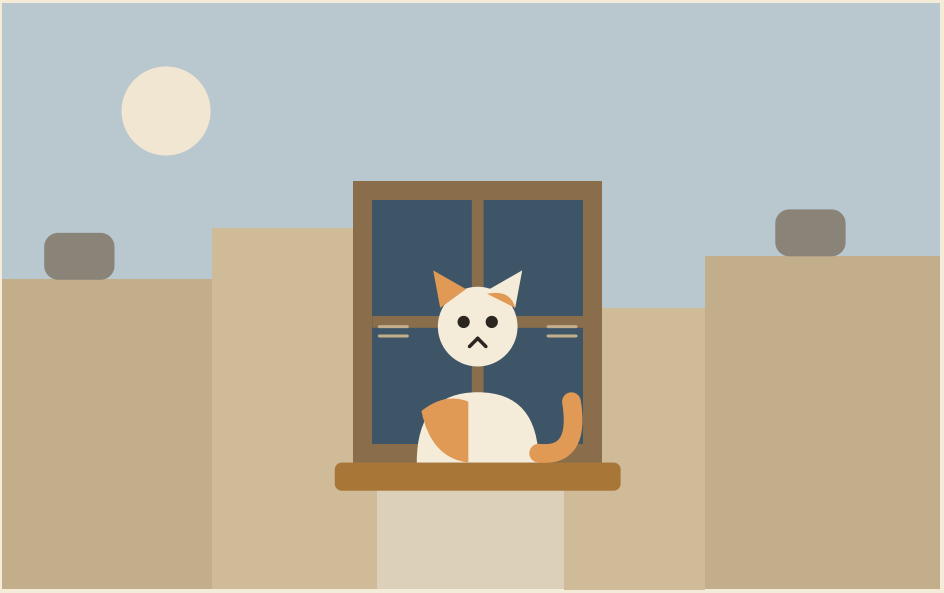
وين راحت مشمش؟

ween raa7at Mishmish?

Where Did Mishmish Go?



اللهجة الفلسطينية — القدس

Spoken Palestinian (Jerusalem). No fus7a, no tashkeel.

Before you start

Same system as book 1: Arabic first, then the Jerusalem pronunciation, then English. This story is built around **asking questions** — the words on this page are the ones you will use every single day.

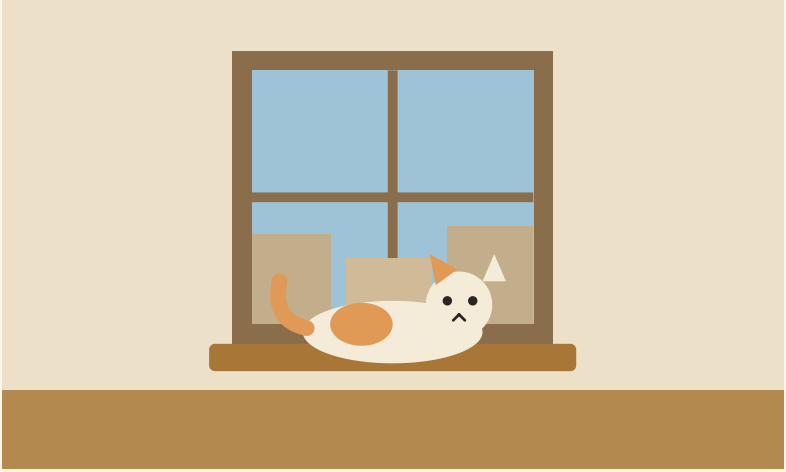
THE CHAT ALPHABET

7	ح	hard breathy H
5	خ	kh
3	ع	ayn
2	ء ق	glottal stop — and ق is a glottal stop in Jerusalem
gh	غ	French-style r

EVERY QUESTION WORD YOU NEED

PALESTINIAN	FUS7A		
شو	ماذا	*shou*	what
مين	مَن	*meen*	who
وين	أين	*ween*	where
ليش	لماذا	*leesh*	why
إمتى	متى	*eemta*	when
كيف	كيف	*keef*	how (same word, but كيفك keefak = how are you)
قديش	كم	*2addeesh*	how much / how many
أي	أي	*ayy*	which

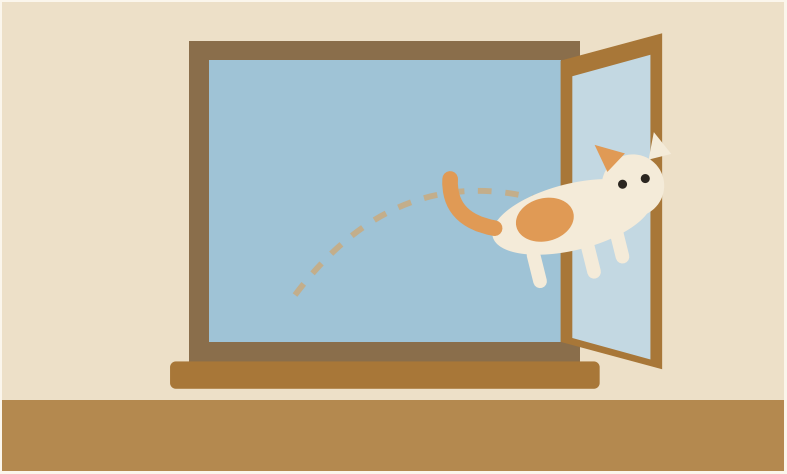
Word order. Unlike fus7a, the question word usually goes exactly where the answer would go, and you do not restructure the sentence: رحت وين؟ *ru7t ween?* "you went where?" is just as



عند سامي قطة اسمها مشمش.
لونها أبيض وبرتقالي.
مشمش بتحب تنام عالشباك وتتفرج عالناس.

3ind Saami 2atta ismha Mishmish.
lonha abyad w-burtu2aani.
Mishmish bit7ibb tnaam 3ash-shibbaak w-titfarraj 3an-naas.

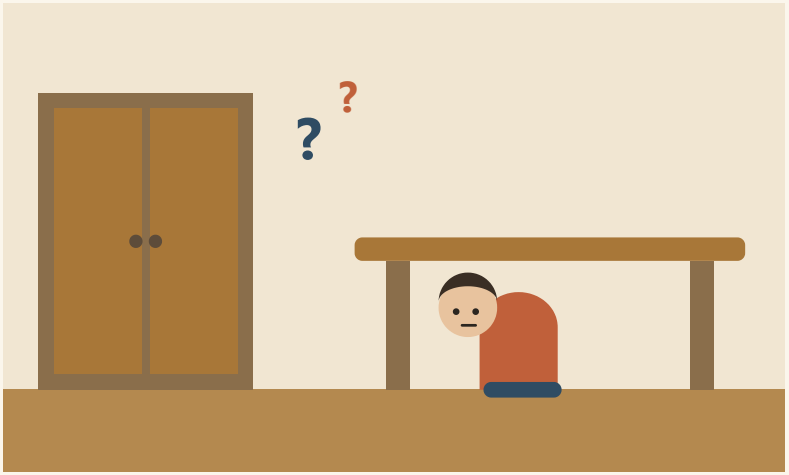
Sami has a cat called Mishmish (“Apricot”). She's white and orange. Mishmish likes sleeping on the window and watching the people go by.



يوم من الأيام، الشباك كان مفتوح.
مشمش قامت، مطت حالها، ونطت برا!

yom min il-ayyaam, ish-shibbaak kaan maftou7.
Mishmish 2aamat, mattat 7aalha, w-nattat barra!

One day, the window was open. Mishmish got up, had a good stretch, and jumped outside!



سامي رجع من المدرسة ونادى:

«مشمش! مشمش! وينك؟»

دور تحت الطاولة... ما في.

دور جوا الخزانة... ولا إشي.

Saami rija3 min il-madrase w-naada:
“Mishmish! Mishmish! weenek?”
dawwar ta7t it-taawle... maa fee.
dawwar juwwa il-5zaane... wala ishi.

Sami came home from school and called out: “Mishmish! Mishmish! Where are you?” He searched under the table... nothing. He searched inside the cupboard... nothing at all.



نزل عالشارع وسأل الجيران:

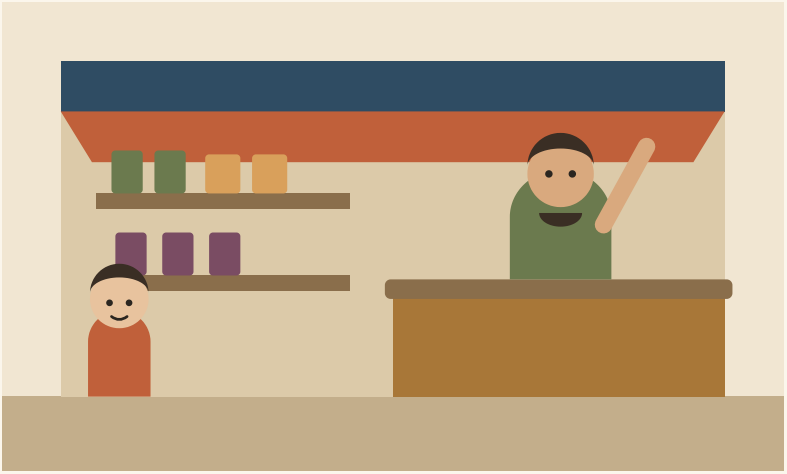
«لو سمحتي يا خالة، شفتي قطة بيضا وبرتقالي؟»

«لأ يا حبيبي، ما شفتها. بس جرب عند الدكانة.»

---

nizil 3ash-shaari3 w-sa2al ij-jeeraan:
“law sama7ti ya 5aale, shufti 2atta beeda w-burtu2aani?”
“la2 ya 7abeebi, maa shuftha. bass jarrib 3ind id-dukkaane.”

He went down to the street and asked the neighbours: “Excuse me, auntie, have you seen a white and orange cat?” “No, love, I haven't seen her. But try at the shop.”



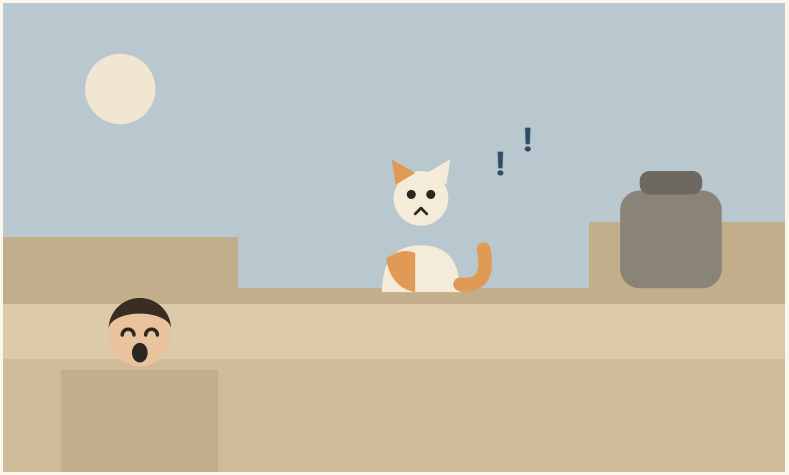
راح عند الدكانة. صاحب الدكانة قله:

«في قطة صغيرة قاعدة فوق عالسطح من الصبح.
وعم بتموء كتير.»

---

raa7 3ind id-dukkaane. saa7ib id-dukkaane 2allo:
“fee 2atta zgheere 2aa3de fo2 3as-sat7 min is-sob7.
w-3am btmoo2 kteer.”

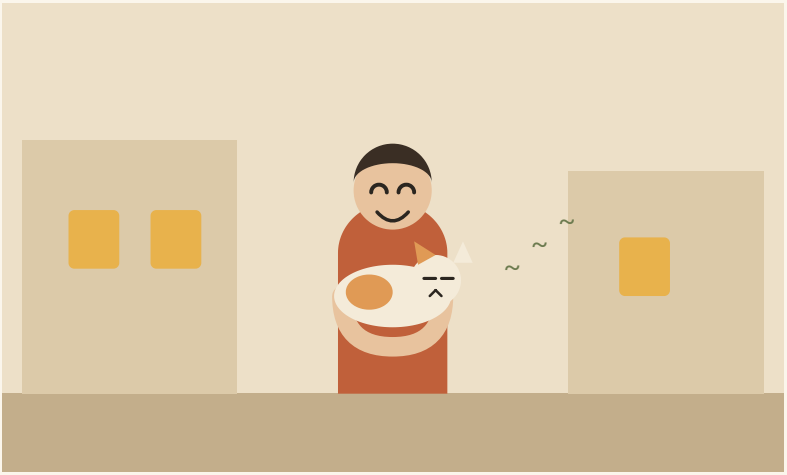
He went to the shop. The shopkeeper said to him: “There's a little cat sitting up on the roof since this morning. And she's meowing a lot.”



سامي طلع عالسطح، وشو شاف؟
مشمش قاعدة عالحيط، وحدها، وخايفة تنزل.

Saami tili3 3as-sat7, w-shou shaaf?
Mishmish 2aa3de 3al-7eet, wa7adha, w-5aayfe tinzal.

Sami went up to the roof, and what did he see? Mishmish sitting on the wall, all by herself, too scared to come down.



«تعالي يا مشمش، ما تخافي، أنا هون.»

حملها ونزل، وهي عم تخرخر عالطريق.

ومن هديك اليوم، سامي بيسكر الشباك قبل ما يروح عالمدرسة.

"ta3aali ya Mishmish, maa t5aafi, ana hoon."
7amalha w-nizil, w-hiyye 3am t5ar5er 3at-taree2.
w-min hadeek il-yom, Saami bisakker ish-shibbaak 2abel ma yrou7 3al-madrase.

"Come here, Mishmish, don't be scared, I'm here." He picked her up and carried her down, and she purred the whole way. And from that day on, Sami shuts the window before he leaves for school.

Words from this story

Everyday Jerusalem vocabulary. Nothing here is book Arabic.

عند سامي	*3ind Saami*	Sami has (there is no verb "to have")
قطة	*2atta*	cat · pl. قطط 2tat
اسمها	*ismha*	her name is · اسمه ismo his name is
لونها	*lonha*	her/its colour
بتحب تنام	*bit7ibb tnaam*	she likes to sleep (2nd verb with no أن)
الشباك	*ish-shibbaak*	the window · pl. شبابيك shababeek
تتفرج على	*titfarraj 3ala*	to watch, to look at
يوم من الأيام	*yom min il-ayyaam*	one day (story opener)
مفتوح	*maftou7*	open · مسكر msakkar shut
قامت	*2aamat*	she got up
مطت حالها	*mattat 7aalha*	she stretched (lit. stretched herself)
نطت	*nattat*	she jumped · نط natt to jump
برا	*barra*	outside · جوا juwwa inside
نادى	*naada*	he called out
وينك؟	*weenek?*	where are you? (f.) · m. وينك weenak

Words from this story · continued

دور	*dawwar*	he searched · دور على dawwar 3ala look for
تحت	*ta7t*	under · فوق fo2 above
الطاولة	*it-taawle*	the table
الخزانة	*il-5zaane*	the cupboard, the wardrobe
ولا إشي	*wala ishi*	nothing at all · إشي ishi thing
الجيران	*ij-jeeraan*	the neighbours · sg. جار jaar
يا خالة	*ya 5aale*	"auntie" — polite for any older woman
شفتي؟	*shufti?*	did you see? (f.) · m. شفت shuft
بيضا	*beeda*	white (f.) · m. أبيض abyad
لأ	*la2*	no · أه / إيه ah / eeh yes
يا حبيبي	*ya 7abeebi*	"love", "dear" — used constantly, to anyone
بس	*bass*	but · also "only", "enough"
جرب	*jarrib*	try! · جرب jarrab he tried
الدكانة	*id-dukkaane*	the corner shop
صاحب الدكانة	*saa7ib id-dukkaane*	the shopkeeper · صاحب owner, friend

Words from this story · continued

قله	*2allo*	he said to him · قلها 2alha to her
قاعدة	*2aa3de*	sitting (f.) · قاعد 2aa3ed (m.)
السطح	*is-sat7*	the roof — where everyone hangs washing
من الصبح	*min is-sob7*	since the morning
بتموء	*btmoo2*	she meows
الحيط	*il-7eet*	the wall · pl. حيطان 7eetaan
وحدها	*wa7adha*	by herself · لحالي la-7aali by myself
خايفة	*5aayfe*	afraid (f.) · خايف 5aayef (m.)
ما تخافي	*maa t5aafi*	don't be afraid (f.) · m. ما تخاف maa t5aaf
هون	*hoon*	here · هناك hnaak there
حملها	*7amalha*	he carried her
عم تخرخر	*3am t5ar5er*	she's purring
من هديك اليوم	*min hadeek il-yom*	from that day on
بيسكر	*bisakker*	he closes · بيفتح byifta7 he opens
قبل ما	*2abel ma*	before (+ verb) · بعد ما ba3ed ma after

Dialect notes

Three things this story quietly drilled into you.

1 · THERE IS NO VERB "TO HAVE"

You use عند *3ind* plus a pronoun ending:
عندي *3indi* I have · عندك *3indak / 3indek* you have (m./f.) · عندو *3indo* he has · عندها *3indha* she has · عنا *3inna* we have · عندهم *3indhom* they have.
Negative: ما عندي *maa 3indi* — I don't have.

2 · THE ENDINGS THAT DO EVERYTHING

The same little endings mark possession on a noun and the object on a verb. Learn them once and they work everywhere.

ـي	*-i*	my / me — اسمي ismi my name
ـك	*-ak (m.) / -ek (f.)*	your / you — وينك weenak, weenek
ـه	*-o*	his / him — قله 2allo he told him
ـها	*-ha*	her — حملها 7amalha he carried her
ـنا	*-na*	our / us — جبلنا jiblna bring us
ـكم	*-kom*	your / you (pl.) — بيتكم beetkom your house
ـهم	*-hom*	their / them — خدهم 5idhom take them

Dialect notes · continued

3 · TELLING SOMEONE TO DO SOMETHING

The imperative is short and blunt, and you soften it with لو سمحت or by adding يا plus a name.

روحوا / روحي / روح *rou7 / rou7i / rou7u* — go (m. / f. / pl.)
تعالوا / تعالي / تعال *ta3aal / ta3aali / ta3aalu* — come
شوفوا / شوفي / شوف *shouf / shoufi / shoufu* — look

Negative commands use ما plus the present, no بـ: ما تخاف *maa t5aaf* don't be afraid · ما تنسى *maa tinsa* don't forget.

> **A word about ش.** In Gaza, Hebron and much of the south you will hear negation wrapped around the verb: ما بعرفش *maa ba3rafsh*. In Jerusalem, Ramallah, and up through Jordan and Syria, people just say ما بعرف *maa ba3ref*. Understand both; produce the second.

WORTH MEMORISING AS WHOLE PHRASES

وينك؟	*weenak?*	where are you?
شو صار؟	*shou saar?*	what happened?
ما بعرف	*maa ba3ref*	I don't know
لحظة	*la7za*	one second
ولا يهمك	*wala yhimmak*	no worries, don't mention it